A-A-53370
29 January 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, EAR (Strut, House)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-F-42032(DM), dated 30 October 1986, which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers one size of strut implantation forceps of the House design for use in microscopic surgery of the ear.

Salient characteristics.

Material. Forceps shall be manufactured from Class 4 martensitic corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard F899.

Hardness. The forceps tips shall have a Rockwell hardness of C48 to C53. Forceps tips shall not vary in hardness by more than five points.

Style and design. Forceps shall be of the dimensions and design of DPSC Drawing 24487. The top lever arm shall be capable of disengaging from the lever pivot for raising and cleaning. The pivot mechanism and lever guide shall operate smoothly, freely and without binding. The pivot mechanisms shall be sufficiently tight to ensure correct alignment of the tips with no free-play or overlap of the tips. The tip mating surfaces shall mate cleanly with no discernable gap at any point of the surfaces.

Passivation. The forceps shall be properly passivated.

Finish. The finish shall be satin. The finish shall be uniform and free from burrs, scale, rough areas, sharp edges, and grind or tool marks.

Markings. Forceps shall be permanently and legibly marked with the manufacturer's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless." In addition, forceps of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Tests. Forceps shall be tested for hardness and corrosion-resistance as specified under Quality Assurance Provisions.

Workmanship. The forceps shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform and free from defects which affect life, utility, or appearance.

Product Quality Level

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Examination. The forceps shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

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Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps. Sampling shall be level S-1, AQL 1.0.

Tests.

Hardness. Forceps shall be treated for Rockwell hardness in accordance with ASTM Standard E18 or ASTM Standards E92 and E140.

Corrosion-resistance. Forceps shall be tested for corrosion resistance in accordance with the Resistance to Boil and Resistance to Copper Sulfate tests of ASTM standard F1089.

Metric Products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specification, standard, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-139-8332	FORCEPS, EAR, House, Strut, Extremely Delicate

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 60141

Project No. 6515-4074

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NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53370	FORCEPS, EAR (Strut, House)

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a Paragraph Number and Wording

b Recommended Wording

c Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

REMARKS

NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last First MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
MAILING ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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